

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate foundational knowledge of security management across Windows® and Linux® networking environments. This event focuses on essential skills in identifying threats, securing systems, and applying core cybersecurity principles. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this objective event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- (Optional) Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified.

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Computer and software

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Previous Business Professionals of America tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied or keyed) may not be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.
- At NLC, contestants will take IT Specialist - Cyber Security certification as part of the event. Contestants passing this certification will have 50 points added to their event score.
 - A Pearson profile must be created at <https://certiport.pearsonvue.com> before attending NLC
 - Contestants must include their BPA Contestant ID in their Pearson profile when they register
 - Certiport Parent/Legal Guardian Consent Form must be uploaded to: education@bpa.org
 - For more information on the exam, visit <https://certiport.pearsonvue.com>
 - Reference materials are not allowed for certification testing
- The top 10 contestants at Nationals will advance to a final round that includes a performance component. Scores from the preliminary round and the objective test will not carry over to the finals. Reference materials may be used during the application portion of the final round.
- Length of event
 - Preliminaries - No more than sixty (60) minutes for objective test
 - Preliminaries - (Nationals only) No more than sixty (60) minutes for objective test, no more than fifty (50) minutes for certification test, and no more than sixty (60) minutes for performance component
 - Finals - (Nationals only) No more than sixty (60) minutes for performance component
- Entries vary by state

Contest Competencies

1. Identify, assess, and mitigate security threats by deploying layered security tactics and managing inbound connections to prevent, detect, and respond to attacks
2. Develop, implement, and manage infrastructure security controls and organizational security policies to safeguard networks, systems, and data while ensuring compliance
3. Apply cryptography, encryption, authentication, and certificate management techniques while monitoring security infrastructure to protect data and detect incidents
4. Harden Windows®, Linux, and network devices by applying security best practices, updates, and configuration controls to reduce vulnerabilities and strengthen network defense
5. Secure and monitor TCP/IP and wireless networks by implementing encryption, authentication, and traffic analysis to prevent unauthorized access